Stage 8. Sustainability

GHG emissions, ENERGY STAR, weather regression and benchmarks

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STATUS Ready to enter

Stage 8 turns the usage and bill data Stages 1-7 already built into the sustainability story: greenhouse-gas emissions computed from that usage, ENERGY STAR property setup and rating requests, a weather-normalized read on four metered points, and the built-in benchmarks that rank buildings against each other. Every emission factor source and the nine benchmark definitions already ship with the product; this stage's job is dating factor values, wiring meters to them, and configuring the two screens (ENERGY STAR, weather regression) that turn existing data into a new report. The Thermal Plant's Ridgeline Wind farm adds one more job: keeping its generation out of the emissions it would otherwise be counted in (see Ridgeline Wind below).

Before you start

- Stages 1-7 are green: companies, the hierarchy, meters and points, bills and rates all exist. Stage 8 does not create a single meter; it only assigns emission factors to ones that already exist.
- Stages 2-7 are being authored in parallel with this one, so this chapter and its files name meters and points by their Stage 2/3 scenario id (the id in `data/scenarios/demo-university-v1.yaml`), not by an installed MeterID. Look each one up by its display name once those stages record real IDs.
- EmissionFactorSource, EmissionFactorSourceMember, EmissionType and EmissionCategory are system lookups, not blank tables: two sources and their members already exist with real published history. Step 1 opens and extends them; it does not create new ones.

Step 1. Emission factor sources and factors

Where: Web, Emission Factor Sources (`#/EmissionFactorSources`) and Emission Factors (`#/EmissionFactors`).

Enter: 01-emission-factors.yaml.

Order inside the screens: open Emission Factor Sources first only to confirm eGRID (source 4) and Non-electric commodities (source 3) are already present with their members CAMX (WECC California) and "Non-electric commodities" — nothing to save there. Then go to Emission Factors, find each member/emission-type row, open its History editor and add a 2024-01-01 row and a 2025-01-01 row so every factor has two different values across the reporting window.

Why two sources are enough: eGRID covers every electric meter (Scope 2 in customer language) and Non-electric commodities covers natural gas (Scope 1) and, once its Commodities list is extended to Potable Water, the water/sewer embedded-energy figure (an approximation of Scope 3). The file explains why chilled water/steam delivered by the Central Plant and Helios's solar generation get no factor of their own, and why Ridgeline's wind generation, which is reported as avoided emissions, gets none either.

Record: nothing new is created; note the effective-dated values you enter.

Check: `emission_sources_and_members`, `emission_factor_history_2024_2025`.

Step 2. Meter emission factor assignment

Where: Web, Meter Emission Factor Assignment (`#/MeterEmissionFactorAssignment`).

Enter: 02-meter-emission-assignments.yaml, 34 meters across the three companies to assign, and the 10 Ridgeline turbine meters to exclude.

Order inside the screen: pick a company node on the hierarchy tree and Show meters, choose the Emission Factor Source, Emission Factor Member and Emission Source Category once under Assignment defaults, then Assign each meter listed and Save. The Unassigned status shows what is left on that node. On the Thermal Plant node, Exclude Ridgeline WTG-01 to WTG-10 first and do not use Assign all (Ridgeline Wind, below).

Record: nothing new; the assignment itself is the record.

Check: `meter_emission_assignments`; for Ridgeline, `ridgeline_turbines_excluded` and `ridgeline_interconnection_assignment`.

Step 3. GHG company configuration

Where: Web, GHG Company Configuration (`#/GHGCompanyConfiguration`).

Enter: 03-ghg-company-configuration.yaml, one record per company.

Order inside the screen: pick the company, set Starting Year 2024 and Ending Year 2025, pick a Default Emission Source Category, then enable every source that company has an assigned meter for from step 2. Do this after step 2: the enabled sources are also the company's automatic assignment list, so the warehouse job maps any meter that step 2 left unassigned and unexcluded and that a source matches.

Record: nothing new.

Check: `ghg_company_config`.

Step 4. ENERGY STAR property setup, rating requests, Portfolio Manager connection

Where: Web, ENERGY STAR Property Setup (`#/ESPropertySetup`) and New Rating Request (`#/ESNewRatingRequest`); Configuration Tool, System Constants; Web, Task Manager (`#/tasks/manager`) for the sync task.

Enter: 04-energy-star.yaml, the 13 properties from `data/scenarios/demo-university-v1.yaml` and their rating requests. See ENERGY STAR integration for the full property mapping this step is entering.

Order inside the screens: confirm the 13 properties on Property Setup (Stage 2 already created the nodes; this maps each one to its ENERGY STAR primary use), then queue rating requests on New Rating Request for 2024-2025. Both screens are fully local and save without a Portfolio Manager account.

Scores are external: ENERGY STAR 1-100 scores only arrive from the Portfolio Manager API, never by hand entry. Obtaining a sandbox account and setting the `CustomerServer` System Constant is Brandon's own action item (product backlog item 1); until then, property and request data still render, only the score columns stay empty. Lakeview Residence Hall and Cedar Row Apartments are the two properties expected to score once

connected; every other property, including Admin Hall, gets metrics only.

Record: nothing new.

Check: `es_properties`, `es_rating_requests`, `es_scores_pending_external`.

Step 5. Weather regression

Where: Web, Custom views (WeatherNormalization_SetPeriod, then _Run, then _MeterDetails).

Enter: 05-weather-regression.yaml, four points.

Order inside the screens: this is UI-then-run. Set the period and pick the point and its weather inputs (HDD, CDD, or both) on _SetPeriod, run it on _Run — this calls the same `FF_wn*` procs the Weather Normalization Sync task (Task 48) uses — and read the fitted coefficients and R^2/CV-RMSE on _MeterDetails. Nothing is hand-entered; the numbers in the file are the expected shape of the result, not values to type.

Record: nothing; the result is computed.

Check: `weather_regression_results`.

Step 6. Benchmarks

Where: nothing to enter. `BenchmarkRanking`, `MonthlyEUI` and `PerformanceSnapshot` already read nine built-in benchmark definitions (`wh_Benchmark`, company -1) including Use per area, Spend per area and CO2 per area — exactly the EUI, cost-intensity and GHG-intensity benchmarks this stage needs. Run those three reports over the campus and Cedar Row buildings once steps 1-5 are in; nothing is created here.

Check: `benchmark_definitions_builtin`.

Ridgeline Wind

Added 2026-10-01 (Ridgeline Wind). The Thermal Plant bought Ridgeline Wind on 2024-07-01: ten 660 kW turbines near Rio Vista, one Valley Electric interconnection, and a monthly transfer statement that EEM generates. The Sustainability Office keeps the renewable energy certificates (one per MWh) and wants the generation reported as avoided emissions at the grid factor, the eGRID CAMX CO2e of the year that step 1 enters (0.1866 kgCO2e/kWh for 2024, 0.1798 for 2025), with the interconnection's station service counted as ordinary Scope 2. It wants the turbine meters' generation counted, not the Valley Electric bill credit, which is money and whose export is measured at the substation, 1.9 percent below what the turbines made.

EEM's GHG screens can report the station service and nothing else of that. They multiply the energy billed to a mapped meter by a factor and keep only positive results; nothing marks a meter as generation (product finding 44), and no REC, market-based or avoided-emissions input exists. A turbine with a factor would add its output to Scope 2, about 420 t CO2e for July 2024 on the step 1 factor rows, against 0.7 t of station service. So the stage keeps the generation out and reports it beside the GHG screens:

- **Exclude the ten turbines (step 2).** On Meter Emission Factor Assignment, choose Exclude on Ridgeline WTG-01 to WTG-10; each shows as Not Calculated. Leaving them Unassigned is not enough: the sources enabled in step 3 are an automatic assignment list, and the warehouse job gives every unassigned, unexcluded electric meter in California a CAMX mapping at the company's default category. Exclude is the one state it skips. Exclude the ten before step 3 saves the Thermal Plant's configuration, and never use Assign all on a node that holds them: from Unassigned it maps them, from Excluded it clears the exclusions.
- **Assign the interconnection meter (step 2).** CAMX, Indirect, like every other electric meter. It counts station service only, so the Valley Electric bill must not carry the export kWh as an energy quantity on that meter (Stage 5): GHG History adds every energy quantity billed to a meter. The same holds for the credit that lands on the Central Plant's September 2024 bill (August 5 to September 4) under VED-BCT: it is money and adds no kWh.
- **Report avoided emissions from the turbine data.** Monthly generated kWh of the ten pad meters times the grid factor of the year, with the RECs at one per generated MWh. July 2024 is 2,251,384 kWh, or 420.11 t CO2e avoided at 0.1866; the hand-made July statement fixes the kWh. EEM supplies the kWh and does not multiply. Helios's statements print its own estimate (0.209 kgCO2e/kWh), which is Helios's figure, not Northlake's.
- **Enter nothing else.** Ridgeline is not an ENERGY STAR property (its two Facilities nodes show as unconfigured rows on Property Setup; leave them), is not in the benchmark peer set (no floor area), and has no weather regression (step 5 records output against wind speed as a goal, finding 42).

Check: `ridgeline_turbines_excluded`, `ridgeline_interconnection_assignment`, `ridgeline_generation_not_in_ghg_history`, `ridgeline_interconnection_energy_quantity`, `ridgeline_bct_credit_is_money`, `ridgeline_avoided_emissions_basis`, `ridgeline_not_benchmarked_or_regressed`.

Stage 8 is done when

- eGRID's CAMX member and Non-electric commodities' gas factor each carry a 2024 and a different 2025 value.
- All 34 electric, gas and water meters across the three companies carry an emission factor assignment, the 10 Ridgeline turbine meters are Excluded, and each company's GHG configuration covers 2024-2025.
- GHG History, GHG Variance and GHG Audit render computed emissions from that assignment, with Ridgeline in them as station service only, and Variance is non-zero between 2024 and 2025.
- Ridgeline's avoided emissions are computed from the turbine meters' generated kWh at the grid factor of the year (420.11 t CO2e for July 2024), and Ridgeline is in no ENERGY STAR, benchmark or weather-regression result.
- All 13 ENERGY STAR properties are mapped and their rating requests queued; once a sandbox Portfolio Manager account is connected, Lakeview Residence Hall and Cedar Row Apartments show a quarterly 1-100 score and the rest show metrics only.
- All four weather regressions have plausible R^2/CV-RMSE, and the three baseline shells from Stages 0/1 now show computed values.
- BenchmarkRanking, MonthlyEUI and PerformanceSnapshot render a ranking across the campus and Cedar Row buildings using the built-in benchmarks.

Run `checks.sql` beside this chapter against the instance database to see each of these as a result set.

Findings

- **ENERGY STAR scores are external.** `ESResponseFacility` only ever populates from the Portfolio Manager API via the EnergyStar sync task (Task 19, `EEMSuite.Tasks.EnergyStar`). Verified: `EnergyStarController.IsConfiguredForRequests` gates `#/ESNewRatingRequest` submission on the `CustomerServer` System Constant. This is product backlog item 1, not a gap introduced by this stage.
- **Company-specific benchmark definitions have no create screen.** Verified: `BenchmarksController.cs` exposes only `GetBenchmarks` and `GetBenchmarkControls`, both `[HttpGet]`; nothing in the Benchmarks stack writes `wh_Benchmark`. The nine built-in, company -1 definitions (step 6) cover this stage's needs, so this finding only blocks a customer wanting its **own** named benchmark or a saved target value. Product backlog item 7.
- **The Non-electric commodities source is CO2-only.** Verified: `EmissionFactorSourceEmissionType` associates source 3 with Emission Type CO2 only, so natural gas and water emissions in this stage are entered as a single already-GWP-inclusive CO2 figure rather than split across CO2/CH4/N2O the way eGRID's electric factor is. Not a blocking gap — the customer's source values were already expressed as CO2-equivalent — but worth knowing before comparing a GHG Audit line to a raw EPA table.
- **Extending a source to a new commodity is unverified end to end.** Adding Potable Water as a commodity on the existing Non-electric commodities source (step 1) was reasoned from the screen's code, not click-tested; confirm the Unit options it offers before entering the water/sewer embedded-energy values.
- **GHG company configuration has no Scope 1/2/3 toggle and no target field.** Its Starting and Ending Year are the baseline GHG Variance compares against, not a reporting range.
- **GHG has no generation or avoided-emissions concept.** Verified: `wh_GHGTableSync` multiplies each mapped meter's billed energy by its factor and keeps only positive results, `wh_GetGHGData` sums them, the Emission Factors save refuses a factor of zero or less, and no REC or market-based input exists. Generation can be excluded (step 2) but not reported as avoided emissions or as a market-based Scope 2 reduction, so Ridgeline's figure, like Helios's, is computed outside the GHG screens. Product finding 59, which extends 44.
- **Unassigned is not excluded (finding 60).** Verified: enabling a source on GHG Company Configuration turns on automatic assignment, and the warehouse job (`CreateDefaultEmissionMeterMap`) maps every unassigned, unexcluded meter whose commodity and address match, at the company's default category, with no regard for Meter Type or generation. Only Exclude stops it, for the Ridgeline turbines and for any other meter that must stay out of GHG History.
- **Weather regression is driven by temperature alone (goal 42).** Verified: the engine regresses a meter's bills on HDD and CDD from one temperature point. `FF_wnCore` has a third-variable slot that the runner never fills and normalization never uses, so output against wind speed stays a goal and no Ridgeline regression is run.

Findings 9, 11, 42, 44, 59 and 60 in product findings carry the benchmark, ENERGY STAR score, regression-driver, generation-role, avoided-emissions and automatic-assignment gaps; finding 61 records that the ENERGY STAR sync reports no export from an on-site array. The other items here are notes from entering this stage.